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TIME & ATTENDANCE POLICY

DOCUMENT HISTORY

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Department	People Excellence
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Reviewed by	Director-People Excellence
Approved by	CEO
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REVISION HISTORY

Issue/Revision		Date	Brief Description of Revision	Author's Sign	Approver's Sign
From	**To**				
-	v.0		New Policy		

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Purpose:

To provide clear guidelines on employee leave policy, eligibility and processes.

Scope:

This policy would be applicable to all employees of Arche Global India Pvt Ltd – As per S & E Act – 1947. Employees working based in client location / project sites – CL Regulation & Abolition Act - 1970

General Guidelines

- Employees are expected to be regular and punctual as per the Organisation policy.
- The reckoning period for all eligible employee leave shall be Calendar year January – December.
- Employees must work for at least 8 hours a day (this includes 30 Minutes lunch break and 15 minutes break twice a day) to meet business requirements.
- Employees from the **Delivery/Professional Services function**, who are based out of an office location, will also fall under the **8-hour workday model**. However, when deputed to a project, they will be expected to follow the **time and attendance policy as defined by the customer.**
- **Flexible Shifts**: Employees may start their day anytime between **8:00 AM and 10:30 AM** (from **7:00 AM** for our Bangalore location).
- **Work from Home**: Up to **2 WFH days per month** are permitted.
- Employees who work in the client locations must adhere to client-specific work calendars, hours, and guidelines. Leave requests must align with both client and company policies.
- Office based employees' attendance will be calculated with reference to the entry made by the employee in the biometrics, office attendance register will be a backup.
- Employees based out of client location and overseas locations, must mark their attendance through HRMS portal.
- Employees who mark their attendance through HRMS portal must regularise their attendance by 20th of every month. Failing which the same would be treated as loss of pay. As an exception, LOP can be reversed only in the following month with necessary approvals from the Department Head and HR Head.
- Line Managers are expected to monitor and address patterns of tardiness through counselling and warnings.
- Repeated tardiness (three or more instances in a month) will result in disciplinary action, as per the company's disciplinary procedures.
- Prior approval from the line manager is required for all business travel (both intercity and intracity) for customer visits or other business reasons. Employees must apply for "On-Duty" in the HRMS portal to document and regularize such travel.

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- Absence from duty due to any reason should be communicated to the line manager over call immediately and should be regularized by appropriate leave request in the HRMS portal on resuming to work.
- Employees may avail leave only with prior approval from concerned line manager.
- Casual Leave must be informed at least 1 day in advance; Privilege Leave must be informed at least 2-3 weeks in advance and in case of sickness it has to be informed at least on the day of availing leave by the employee.
- Leave over and above their credit limit will be considered as Loss of Pay.
- Leave will be sanctioned subject to the exigencies of work and cannot be claimed as a matter of right. Acceptance or refusal of the request shall be duly communicated to the employee concerned.
- All leave must be informed by submitting a leave requisition through HRMS and to be approved by the line manager. Employees can avail maximum of 2 days leave per month. However, Sick leave and Privilege leave will be sanctioned on a case-to-case basis.
- Medical certificates and other relevant documents need to be produced by the concerned employee who has availed sick leave more than 2 days, to HR via email for the period of absence.
- Employees can en-cash their privilege leave at the end of the financial year wherein they will be paid basic salary for the days they have accumulated in their PL balance up to a maximum of 24 days.
- Employee who has worked on weekly off/holiday can avail compensatory off based on the approval from the line manager. In such case, the concerned employee should notify the details of the compensatory off to the HR Personal through mail
- Employees can club SL and PL, upon approval from the Department Head and HR Head.
- In case of any exception to this policy, the concerned employee must provide a justification, which will be reviewed by their line manager. The line manager will then provide a recommendation, which must be approved by both the Department Head and the HR Head, for further processing.

Leave Eligibility:

Employment Type	Probationary Leave	Casual Leave (CL)	Sick Leave (SL)	Privilege Leave (PL)
Full-Time (5-day week)	-	12 days	12 days	12 days
Full-Time (6-day week)	-	12 days	12 days	15 days
Probationers	6 Days	Not Applicable		

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1. **Casual Leave (CL):**

   12 days of casual leave is credited on a yearly basis, which will lapse at the end of the year and cannot be carried forward to the next year. 1 CL can be availed at a time and employees cannot avail more than 2 CL in a month.

2. **Sick Leaves (SL):**

   12 days of sick leave is credited on a yearly basis. Up to 24 days of SL can be accumulated over a period of 2 years and the same will lapse by end of 2 years.

3. **Privileged Leaves (PL):**

- PL can be availed for taking off from work for marriage (Self or family members) and for personal emergencies/exigencies. Privilege leave can be carried forward to next year with maximum of 24 days (i.e.) 2 years of leave can be accumulated.
- During the 1st year of employment, PL will be credited to all confirmed employees, on a pro-rata basis from his/her date of joining. If an employee exits during the probation period, the respective PL days calculated on a pro-rata basis from the date of joining, will be encashed to the concerned employees along with their full and final settlement.
- Weekly Off / Holiday are not excluded if taken on either side on PL. Ex: PL from Friday to Thursday will be counted as 7 days of PL.

4. **Maternity Leave**:

   - According to the Maternity Benefit Amendment Act, Women employees will be allowed to avail paid maternity leave of 26 weeks.
   - Under the Maternity Benefit Amendment Act, this benefit could be availed by women for a period extending up to a maximum of 8 weeks before the expected delivery date and the remaining time can be availed post childbirth. For women who are expecting after having 2 children, the duration of paid maternity leave shall be 12 weeks (i.e., 6 weeks pre and 6 weeks post expected date of delivery).
   - Maternity leave of 12 weeks to be available to mothers adopting a child below the age of three months from the date of adoption as well as to the commissioning mothers.
   - An applicant for maternity leave must give notice to the company supported by a medical certificate not less than 8 weeks prior to the start of the leave period.

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- Maternity leave may be availed in combination with other leave entitlements, upon approval from department head.
- No pay shall be due or payable in lieu of un-availed maternity leave.

5. **Paternity Leave**

- All male employees are eligible to apply for paternity leave. This leave is specifically provided to fathers to support their partners and care for their newborn or newly adopted child.
- This policy applies whether the child is born biologically or through adoption, provided the child is under three months old at the time of adoption.
- **Duration**: Fathers are entitled to **7 days of paid paternity leave**.
- This leave can be taken consecutively or split into smaller segments, depending on the company's leave policies and the employee's needs, to best support the family during this critical time.
- **Application Process**: The employee should inform HR and submit a formal application for paternity leave as early as possible, ideally at least two weeks before the anticipated start date.
- It can be used only within three months of the child's arrival.
- **Non-Transferable**: Paternity leave is exclusively for the father and cannot be transferred to another individual or combined with other leave types.

6. **Leave during Notice Period**
    - Employees are not eligible to take any leave while serving their notice period.
    - Any leave taken during this period will be considered as loss of pay.

7. **Public holidays:** Eleven public holidays may be availed, as notified by the company at the beginning of each year.
8. **Applying for Restricted Holiday (RH):** Any employee can avail 2 RH in a year and the same has to applied in the HRMS seeking approval the line manager 2 days in advance.
9. **Probationary Leave:** Employees on Probation period can avail 1 day leave per month and the same has to applied in the HRMS seeking approval the line manager 2 days in advance.

10. **Compensatory Leave (CO):**

- Applicable only for working on declared holidays.
- Requires **prior approval** from both the line manager and Department Head.
- Employees must work **8 hours** on the holiday to claim 1 day of CO.
- CO must be availed within **2 months,** or it will lapse, and only **1 day** can be availed at a time.

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11. Leave Without Pay (LWP):

- If an employee exhausts their leave balance, they may request Leave Without Pay.
- A request must be made with a clear indication of the leave type, reason, and duration for approval by the line manager. LOP may only be availed after receiving approval.

12. Unauthorized Leave:

Employees who fail to attend work for **more than 2 consecutive working days** without obtaining permission or approved leave will be considered as engaging in **unauthorized absence**.

Reporting Process: The respective **Reporting Manager** is responsible for notifying the HR department of any unauthorized absence. Upon notification, efforts will be made by the Reporting Manager and HR to contact the employee via email, phone calls, and/or messages to understand the situation.

Instances Considered as Unauthorized Absence:

- Failure to return to work after a scheduled annual leave or any other approved leave.
- Non-compliance with the organization's sickness absence reporting procedure or failure to provide required medical documentation.
- Absence beyond the period unpaid leave, or other prolonged absences without due notification or approval.
- **Consequences**: Unauthorized absence is treated as a disciplinary offence.
- The employee may face actions ranging from a written warning to termination of employment, depending on the severity and frequency of the misconduct. The organization views this as gross misconduct, and necessary steps will be taken in accordance with the company's disciplinary policy.

13. Policy to avail Work From Home (WFH):

Eligibility and Scope

- All Employees working a standard 5-day week whose roles does not require constant in-person interaction may be eligible for WFH arrangements.
- **Employees in Digital Transformation department**: Due to the nature of their roles, these employees are **not eligible** for WFH. This decision is based on the need for consistent in-person client engagement and collaboration with team members.

Work From Home Days

- Eligible employees may avail work from home **2 days a month.**

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Guidelines:

- No WFH on **Mondays or Fridays** to ensure team cohesion at the beginning and end of the week.
- Employees cannot take **two consecutive days** of remote work to promote regular in-office collaboration.
- WFH cannot be availed by employees serving notice period to facilitate smooth transition and knowledge transfer.

Request and Approval Process

- Employees wishing to work from home must submit a request to their line manager at least **two business days in advance**, by applying through HRMS portal.
- The request should specify the proposed WFH days and reasons for the arrangement.
- Line Managers will respond to requests within **two business days**, confirming approval or suggesting alternative arrangements.

Work Hours and Availability

- Employees must maintain their regular working hours (8 hours) while working from home.
- All employees are expected to be available via communication channels throughout the working hours, especially during the core business hours from **10:30 AM to 5:30 PM IST.**

Communication and Collaboration

- Employees must ensure effective communication with their teams and managers while working remotely.
- Regular check-ins via video calls or team meetings are encouraged to maintain engagement and collaboration.
- Employees working from home are required to maintain active presence on Microsoft Teams during official working hours. This includes:

Availability:

  - Employees must remain online and responsive on Microsoft Teams throughout their designated work hours.
  - Status should accurately reflect availability (e.g., "Available" or "Busy" when working, and "Away" only during breaks).

Team Meetings:

  - Participation in scheduled meetings or calls on Microsoft Teams is mandatory unless prior approval for absence is granted.

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Communication:

- Employees are expected to respond to messages and calls within a reasonable time frame to ensure seamless collaboration.

Monitoring:

- Supervisors may periodically monitor Teams activity to ensure compliance with this policy.

Non-compliance with these requirements may result in further review and corrective action as per company guidelines.

Technology and Security

- Employees are responsible for maintaining a secure work environment at home, including using company-approved devices and secure internet connections.
- IT support will be available for any technical issues encountered while working from home.

14. Client Site Policy for Employees

- **Work Calendar Compliance:** Employees assigned to client sites are required to follow the client's designated work calendar. This includes aligning with the client's official holidays, work hours, and other scheduling requirements.
- **Work Hours and Timing:** Working hours, start and end times, as well as any breaks, will be according to the client's schedule. Employees must adhere to these hours unless specific arrangements are approved by both the client and the company.
- **Leave and Holidays:**
  - Leave policies, including holidays and designated breaks, are determined by the client's calendar. Employees must follow the client's holiday and should coordinate with both the client and line manager for any planned absences.
  - **Approval Process:** All leave requests should be submitted in advance, respecting both the client's and company's leave approval process.
- **Adherence to Client Policies:** Employees are expected to follow any additional workplace guidelines or protocols established by the client while on-site, including security, dress code, and conduct standards.

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Guidelines on Attendance & Access Compliance

- **Personal Responsibility:** Employees must use their own credentials (biometric, access card, or login ID) to record attendance.
- Credentials are strictly personal and non-transferable.

Prohibited Practices

- Sharing or exchanging credentials for the purpose of marking attendance on behalf of another employee.
- Attempting to manipulate or falsify attendance records in any manner.

Monitoring & Investigation

- Attendance records will be periodically reviewed by the People Excellence team.
- Any anomalies or irregularities will be formally investigated.

Consequences of Violation

- **First Instance**: Formal written warning
- **Repeated/Deliberate Attempts**: Treated as gross misconduct, leading to disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment.

Accountability

- Employees are personally responsible for the integrity of their attendance records.
- Managers are accountable for ensuring team compliance.

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